Weekly Progress Report

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I. Overview:

This week, the primary focus was on understanding Meta Ads Manager and its audience targeting options. The main task was to create an optimized Meta Ads audience for an EdTech company's Digital Marketing course, by identifying suitable location, age, language, demographics, interests and behaviors, along with reasons for each choice.

II. Achievements:

1. Meta Ads Familiarization:

- Explored Meta Ads Manager and Meta Business Help Center to understand ad account structure and audience settings.
- Learned the difference between Core, Custom and Lookalike audiences and how the Audience Size indicator works.

2. Project: Meta Ads Audience for an EdTech Company

Name of the project: Create a Meta Ads audience for an EdTech Company for their Digital Marketing course

- Researched the target learner profile and finalized the audience criteria (summarised in the table below).
- Documented findings and the reason behind every targeting choice to keep the audience focused and cost-effective.

Criteria	Selected Targeting	Reason for Choice
Location	India: Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune, Kolkata, plus Tier-2 cities (Jaipur, Lucknow, Indore, Patna)	Metro cities have the most students and working professionals; Tier-2 cities have a growing upskilling demand with lower CPM/CPC.
Age	18 - 35 years	Covers college students, fresh graduates and early-career professionals, the group most likely to enrol in a digital marketing course.
Language	English and Hindi	Course content and ads work best in English; Hindi widens reach across North and Central India.
Gender	All genders	The course has no gender bias. Ad performance can be checked later to narrow it down.
Demographics	Education: college students, recent graduates, bachelor's degree; Job titles: marketing executive, freelancer, business owner; Life event: recently graduated	These people are looking for career growth, skill addition or a career switch, so intent to learn is high.
Interests	Digital marketing, Social media marketing, SEO, Online advertising, Online education, E-learning, Entrepreneurship, Freelancing, Career development	Shows direct or closely related interest in the course topic and in learning online.
Behaviors	Engaged shoppers, Small business owners, Online learners / frequent Facebook and Instagram users, Mobile device users	Targets people who are active online, comfortable with online payments and already used to online learning.

Criteria	Selected Targeting	Reason for Choice
Placements	Instagram Feed and Reels, Facebook Feed, Stories	Target age group spends most of its time on these placements, which gives better reach and engagement.

3. Learning Digital Marketing:

- Understood key metrics such as Reach, CTR, CPC, CPM and ROI, and how audience quality affects them.
- Applied the learning to the EdTech use case to build an audience with better return on investment.

III. Challenges:

1. Audience Size Balancing:

- Faced difficulty in keeping the audience neither too broad (wasted budget) nor too narrow (limited reach).
- Ongoing efforts to test different interest and behavior combinations to find the right balance.

2. Choosing the Right Interests and Behaviors:

- Many similar interest options are available in Meta Ads Manager, so it was hard to decide which ones truly match course buyers.
- Seeking guidance from mentors to validate the selection.

IV. Learning Resources:

1. Meta Ads Documentation:

- Utilized Meta Business Help Center and Meta Blueprint for reference on audience targeting.
- Attended relevant webinars and online tutorials to deepen understanding.

2. Digital Marketing Learning Resources:

- Engaged with the UpSkill Campus Digital Marketing course material to strengthen fundamentals.
- Referred to marketing blogs and communities for practical examples of EdTech advertising.

V. Next Week's Goals:

1. Audience Enhancement:

- Refine the audience by exploring Custom and Lookalike audiences and comparing estimated audience size.
- Collaborate with peers to discuss improvements in the targeting strategy.

2. Campaign Development:

- Move to ad creative, copy and budget planning for the EdTech campaign.
- Seek feedback from mentors and peers for continuous improvement.

VI. Additional Comments:

Good progress was made in understanding Meta Ads audience targeting. The week gave practical clarity on how each targeting option affects reach and cost, and on the importance of justifying every choice with a clear reason. Discussions with peers were helpful in improving the final audience.